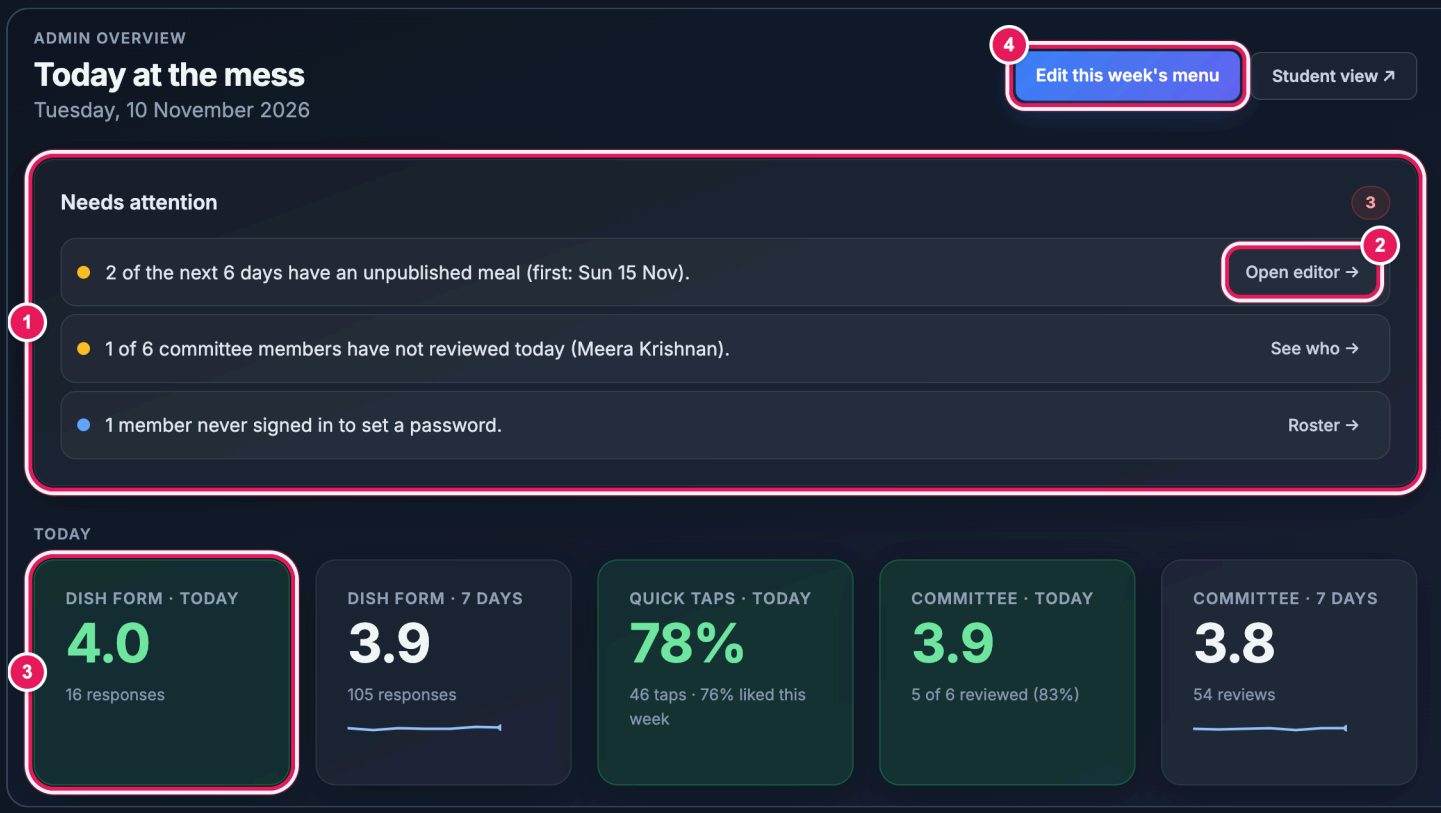
MESSMATE

How to use MessMate

A step-by-step picture guide for **management, deans and the Food Committee**. Every screen, and every button you need to click.



Before you start

MessMate collects feedback on the mess food in three separate ways and shows it to the people who can act on it. The three are **never averaged together**.

How to read this guide

1 A **red number** on a screenshot matches the same red number in the text beside or above it.

A **red outline** shows the button or box you click or type in.

Bold **Bold text** is the part you must not miss, or the exact name of a button.

The screenshots use sample data. The names, scores and menus are examples. Your screens will show your own mess.

The three kinds of feedback

Quick taps
Students tap **Good, Bad or Skipped** once per meal. No sign-in. Shown as the **% who liked** the meal.

Dish form
Students score lunch and each dish from **1 to 5**. No sign-in. Shown as an **average out of 5**.

Committee review
Food Committee members, **signed in and named**, score every dish and five areas for each meal. Shown as an **average out of 5**.

Find your task

I want to...	Go to section	Page
Sign in for the first time, or set my password	1 · Sign in and set your password	**4**
See what needs a decision today	3 · Overview	**6**
Publish or change the menu	4 · Publish the weekly menu	**8**
Add a committee member, or reset a password	5 · Committee members	**10**
Review today's breakfast, lunch or dinner	6 · Review a meal	**12**
See how students rated the food	8 · Student feedback dashboard	**15**
See how the committee scored the mess	9 · Committee dashboard	**17**
Understand a colour, a "--" or an error message	11 · Colours and quick answers	**19**

Contents, and who can open each page

Section		Page	Admin (mess office)	Dean or viewer	Committee member
Part 1 · Get started					
1	Sign in and set your password	4	Yes	Yes	Yes
2	The top bar	5	Yes	Yes	Yes
Part 2 · Run the mess office					
3	Overview: today at the mess	6	Yes	No	No
4	Publish the weekly menu	8	Yes	No	No
5	Committee members	10	Yes	No	No
Part 3 · Review the food					
6	Review a meal	12	No	No	Yes
7	Committee member dashboard	14	No	No	Yes
Part 4 · Read the results					
8	Student feedback dashboard	15	Yes	Read only	No
9	Committee dashboard	17	Yes	Read only	No
10	What students see	18	Open to everyone, no sign-in		
Part 5 · Reference					
11	Colours and quick answers	19	For all readers		

1 Sign in and set your password

Everyone signs in on the same page. **Your email decides which pages you get**; you do not choose a role. Students never sign in.

Address: your MessMate link followed by `/signin` | **Used by:** admin, dean, committee members

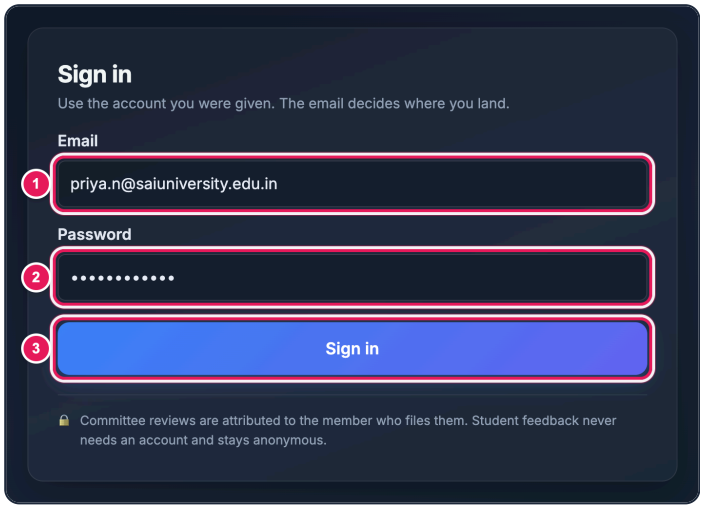
1.1 Sign in 1.2 First time only: choose your own password

1.1 Sign in

Use the account you were given.

1. Type your **email**.
2. Type your **password**. A new committee member types the **one-time password** the admin sent.
3. Click **Sign in**.

Where you land. Admin opens the **Overview**. A dean opens the **Student feedback dashboard**. A committee member opens the **committee dashboard**.



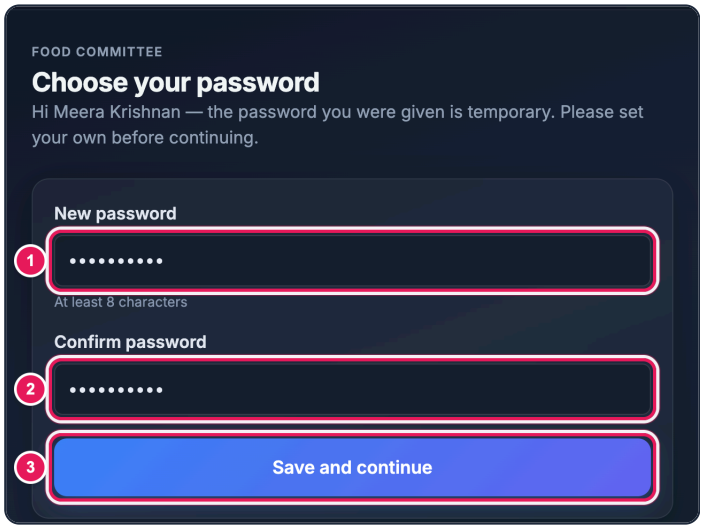
Sign in page. The same card for every role.

1.2 First time only: choose your own password

Committee members see this page the first time they sign in, and again after the admin resets their password.

1. Type a **new password** of **at least 8 characters**.
2. Type the same password again.
3. Click **Save and continue**.

You cannot review a meal until you do this. If you forget your password later, ask the admin to reset it.



Choose your password page.

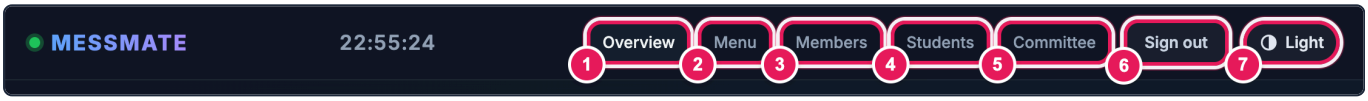
2 The top bar

The bar at the top of every page is how you move around. It shows different links depending on who is signed in.

2.1 Signed in as admin 2.2 Signed in as a dean or viewer 2.3 Signed in as a committee member

2.1 Signed in as admin

1. **Overview**: today on one screen.
2. **Menu**: publish the weekly menu.
3. **Members**: add and manage committee members.
4. **Students**: the student feedback dashboard.
5. **Committee**: the committee dashboard.
6. **Sign out**: always sign out on a shared computer.
7. **Light / Dark**: switches the screen colours. This guide shows the **dark** screen; the light one works the same way.



Admin top bar. The link for the page you are on is shaded.

2.2 Signed in as a dean or viewer

1. **Students**: the student feedback dashboard.
2. **Committee**: the committee dashboard.
3. **Sign out**.



Read-only top bar. A dean can read both dashboards but cannot change the menu or the committee.

Were you sent a dashboard link instead? A link that contains `?token=` opens the same two dashboards without signing in. **Do not forward it**: anyone with the link can read the dashboards.

2.3 Signed in as a committee member

1. **Menu**: today's menu, the page students see.
2. **Rate dish**: the students' dish form.
3. **Dashboard**: your committee dashboard.
4. **Committee**: review a meal.



Committee member top bar. Sign out is on the page itself, top right.

3 Overview: today at the mess

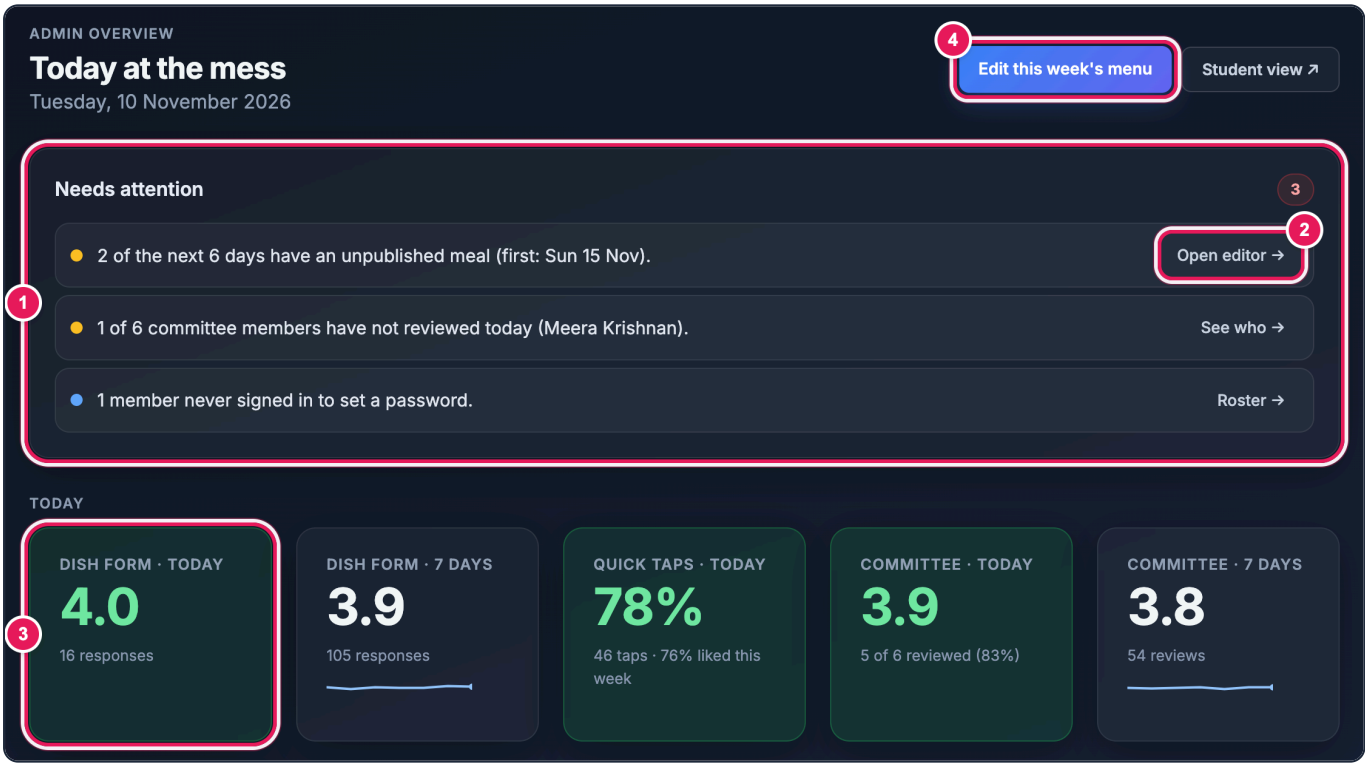
The first page an admin sees. It puts today on one screen and tells you what needs a decision.

Top bar: Overview	Address: `/admin`	Used by: admin

3.1 Start with Needs attention 3.2 What puts a line in Needs attention 3.3 Today's menu and the week ahead
3.4 Who has reviewed, and the latest feedback

3.1 Start with Needs attention

1. **Needs attention** lists everything that needs a decision today. If the list is empty, nothing is waiting.
2. Click the **link at the end of a line** to go straight to the page that fixes it.
3. **Today's numbers** start here and run across the page. Each card is one kind of feedback. A grey **--** means **no data yet, not zero**.
4. **Edit this week's menu** opens the menu editor.



Overview, top of the page. A sixth card, Menu · next 7 days, sits just below.

3.2 What puts a line in Needs attention

- A meal **today or in the next six days** is not published.
- **Fewer than 40%** liked a meal, once five students have rated it.
- Members have not reviewed today. Shown **from 3 pm**.
- Students score lunch or a dish **below 2.5 out of 5**.
- The committee scored an area **below 2.5**.
- A member has **never signed in** to set a password.

3.3 Today's menu and the week ahead

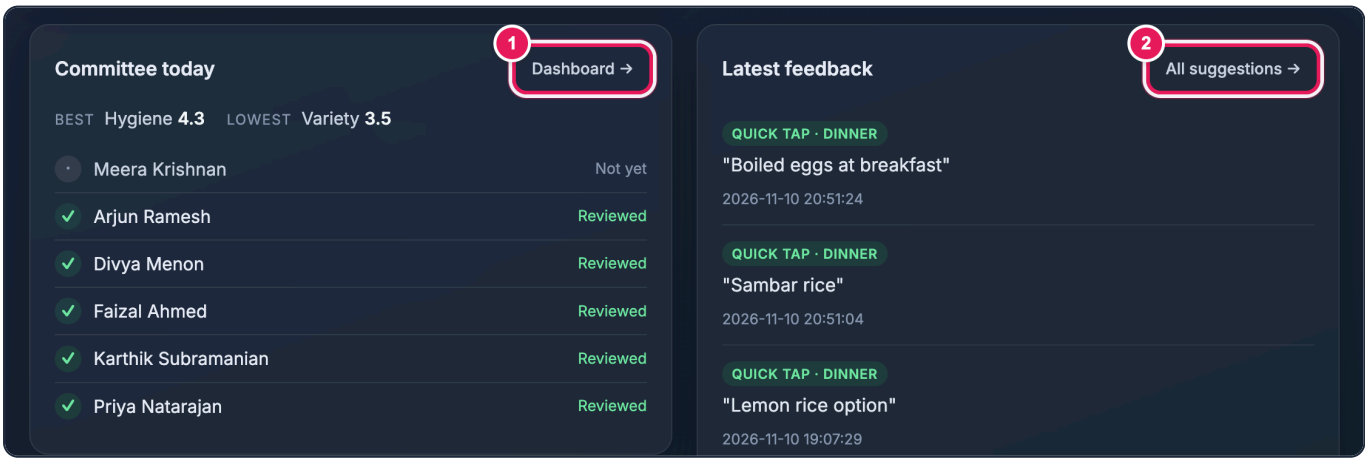
1. **Edit** opens the menu editor for this week. The coloured bar under each meal shows students' quick taps.
2. **Publication** shows the next seven days. A **green dot** is published. A **dotted red ring** is **not published**. B, L and D are breakfast, lunch and dinner.
3. **Open editor** takes you to the menu editor to fill the gaps.



Overview, middle of the page.

3.4 Who has reviewed, and the latest feedback

1. **Dashboard** opens the full committee dashboard. The list shows each member as **Reviewed** or **Not yet**.
2. **All suggestions** opens the student dashboard. Each comment is labelled with where it came from.



Overview, bottom of the page. The feedback list continues below.

4 Publish the weekly menu

Students only see a menu once it is published. A meal left blank shows them **“Menu not published yet”**.

Top bar: Menu	Address: `/admin/menu`	Used by: admin

4.1 Pick the week and fill it quickly 4.2 Publish one day 4.3 Or import the week from a spreadsheet file
4.4 Three ways to publish, one result

4.1 Pick the week and fill it quickly

The page shows one card per day, Monday to Sunday. The line under the title counts how many meals are published.

1. **Prev**, **This week** and **Next** move between weeks.
2. **Fill blanks from template** copies the standard weekly menu into every empty box.
3. **Copy last week** copies last week's published menu into every empty box.
4. **Save all 7 days** publishes the whole week in one click.

Nothing you typed is overwritten. Both fill buttons only touch empty boxes. **Nothing is published until you click a Save button.**

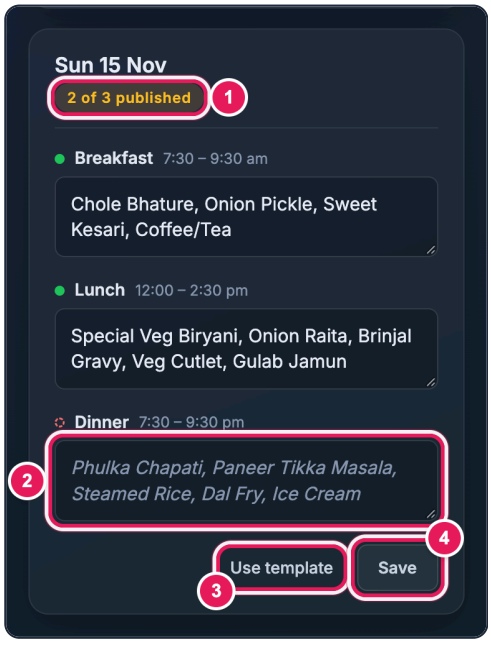


Menu editor, top of the page.

4.2 Publish one day

1. The badge shows the day's state: **Published**, **2 of 3 published** or **Not published**.
2. Type the dishes, **separated by commas**, for example `Idli, Sambar, Chutney`. **Faint slanted text is only a hint**: that meal is **not published**.
3. **Use template** fills this day's empty boxes with the standard menu.
4. Click **Save** to publish this day.

Students see it straight away. A saved menu appears on the student page immediately.



One day card. Dinner is not published yet.

4.3 Or import the week from a spreadsheet file

1. Click **Download blank template**. You get a CSV file for the week on screen, with the columns `Date, Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner`.
2. Fill it in Excel or Google Sheets, save it as a **CSV**, then click **Choose file** and pick it.
3. Click **Upload CSV**.



Import from CSV card, on the menu editor page.

Rules for the file. Dates are written `YYYY-MM-DD`. Keep each meal's dishes **in one cell**, separated by commas. The file must be **under 1 MB**. A date that already has a menu is **updated**, not duplicated. A blank cell publishes nothing. Rows with a bad date are skipped and listed.

4.4 Three ways to publish, one result

Way	Best for	Students see it
Menu editor	Day-to-day changes, or filling a week from the template	**Immediately** after Save
CSV import	A whole week planned in a spreadsheet	**Immediately** after Upload CSV
The Google Sheet	Staff who prefer to type into the `menu` tab, one row per date	Within **30 seconds**

MessMate never shows students a made-up menu. The standard weekly menu is only a typing aid for you. Until you save, students see “Menu not published yet”.

5 Committee members

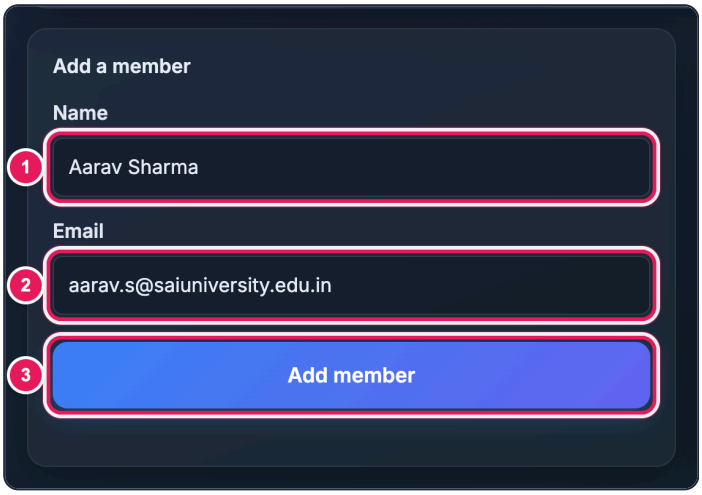
Add the people who review the food, hand them a one-time password, and retire them when they leave.

Top bar: Members	Address: `/admin/members`	Used by: admin

5.1 Add one member 5.2 Copy the one-time password straight away 5.3 Read and manage the list
5.4 Add many members at once

5.1 Add one member

1. Type the member's **name**.
2. Type their **email**. This is what they sign in with.
3. Click **Add member**.

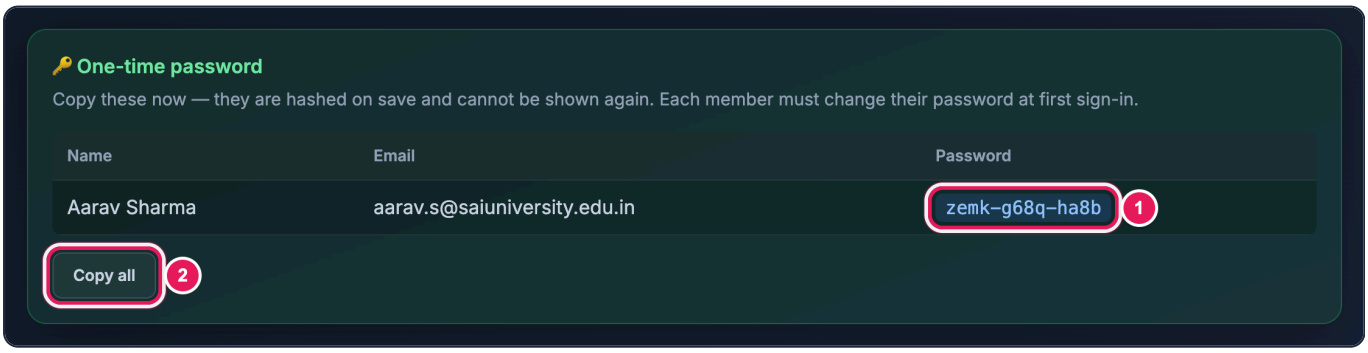


Add a member card, bottom left of the Members page.

5.2 Copy the one-time password straight away

1. The **one-time password** appears at the top of the page.
2. **Copy all** copies every new password at once. Send each member theirs **privately**.

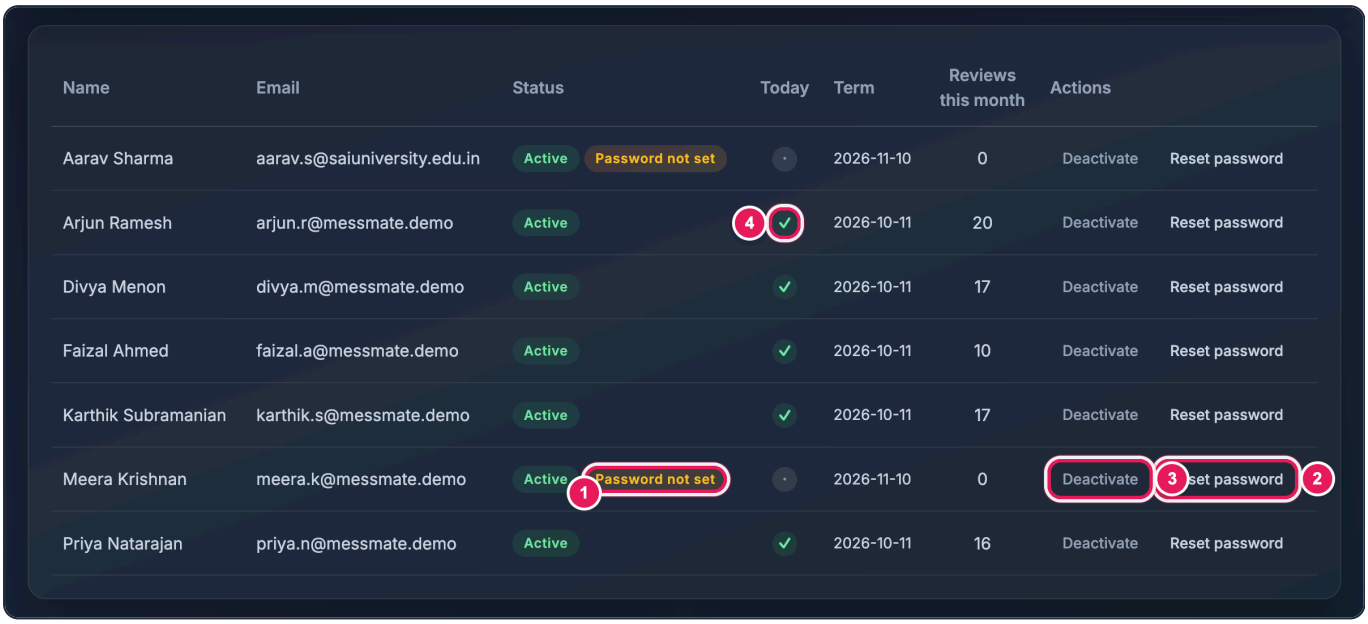
It is shown only once. If you leave the page without copying it, it **cannot be shown again**. Use **Reset password** to make a new one.



One-time password box. Appears after you add a member or reset a password.

5.3 Read and manage the list

1. **Password not set** means the member has not signed in yet.
2. **Reset password** gives a locked-out member a new one-time password.
3. **Deactivate** a member who leaves the committee. **Reactivate** brings them back.
4. A **tick** means the member has reviewed today. A **dot** means not yet.



Members list. One row per member.

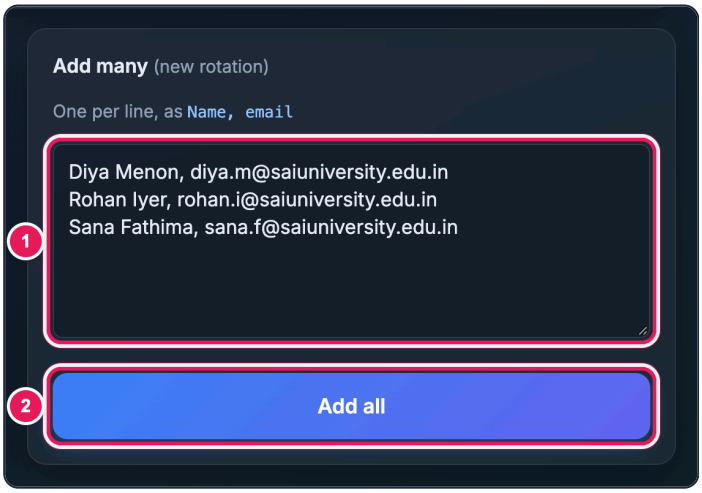
There is no delete. Deactivating keeps a member's past reviews. To change the committee, **deactivate** the outgoing members and **add** the new ones.

5.4 Add many members at once

Use this at the start of a new committee.

1. Type or paste **one member per line**, as `Name, email`.
2. Click **Add all**.

A bad line does not stop the rest. Lines with a problem are listed separately and the others are still added.



Add many card, bottom right of the Members page.

6 Review a meal

Five steps, done **once for each meal** every day. **Reviews are not anonymous**: your name is saved with every review.

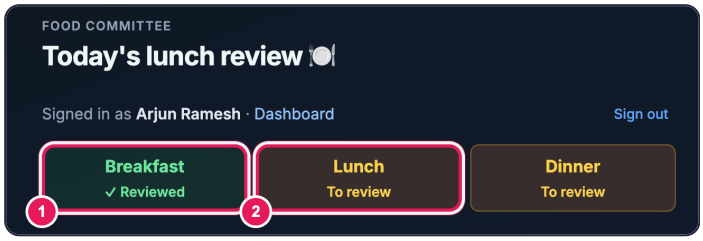
Top bar: Committee	Address: `/committee`	Used by: committee members

6.1 Pick a meal 6.2 Rate every dish 6.3 Rate the five areas 6.4 Add a note and submit
6.5 Review the next meal

6.1 Pick a meal

1. A **green** meal marked **✓ Reviewed** is done.
2. An **amber** meal marked **To review** still needs you. Click it.

The page chooses for you. It opens on the latest meal served that you have not reviewed.



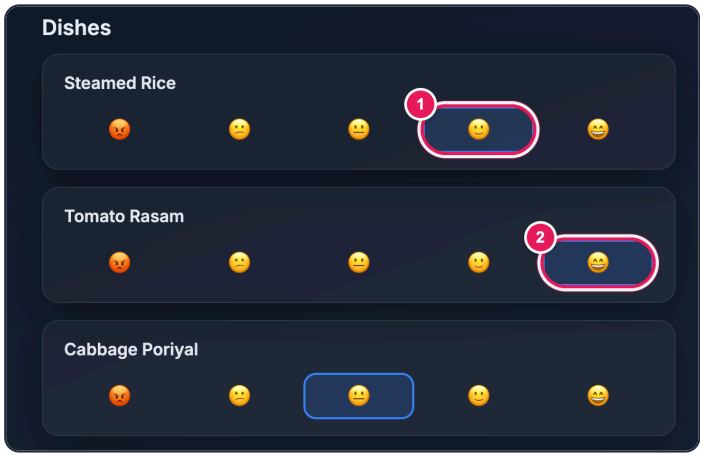
Meal tabs, at the top of the review page.

6.2 Rate every dish

Each dish on today's published menu has its own card. Click one face per dish, from **1 (worst, left)** to **5 (best, right)**.

1. Clicking a face selects it. The selected face is **highlighted**.
2. Do the same for **every dish** in the list.

No dishes listed? The menu for that meal is not published. Rate only the five areas in the next step.

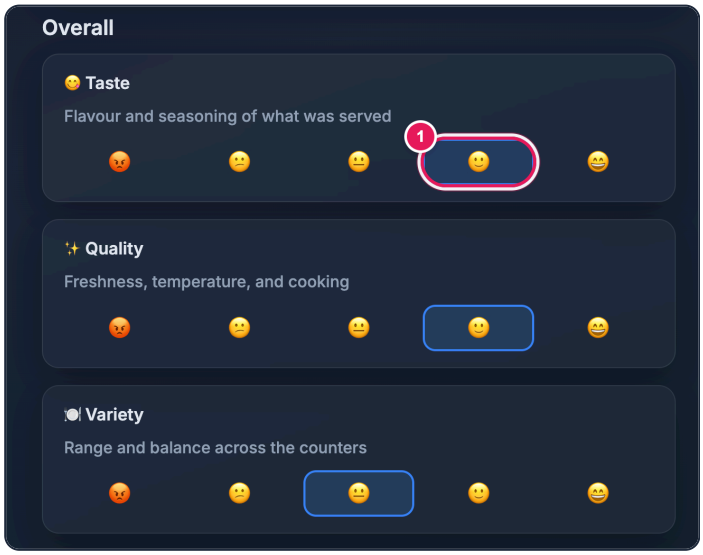


Dishes, the first part of the review form.

6.3 Rate the five areas

1. Click one face for each area, the same way as the dishes.

Taste	Flavour and seasoning
Quality	Freshness, temperature and cooking
Variety	Range and balance across the counters
Hygiene	Cleanliness of food, counters and utensils
Menu	Did the meal match the published menu?

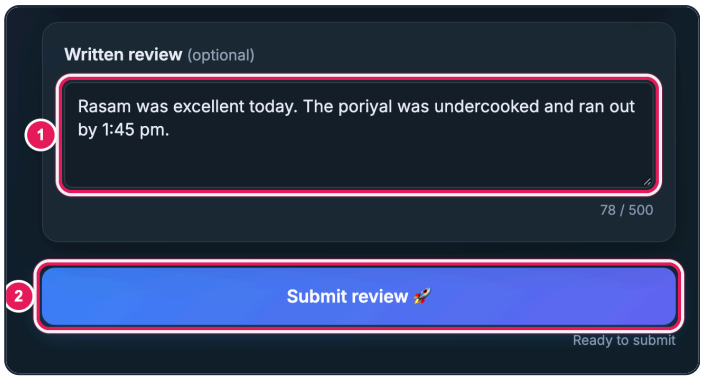


Overall, the second part of the review form. Hygiene and Menu follow below.

6.4 Add a note and submit

1. Write a short review if it would help the kitchen act. It is **optional**, up to **500 characters**.
2. Click **Submit review**.

Is the button faded and not clickable? You have missed a dish or an area. The line under the button tells you how many are rated.

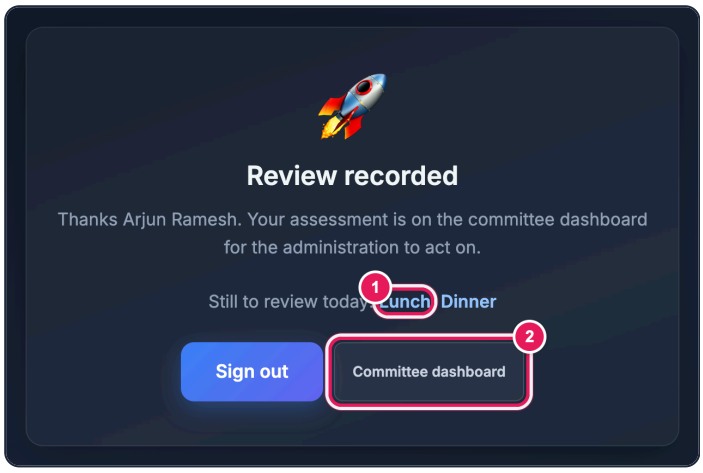


Written review and Submit, at the bottom of the form.

6.5 Review the next meal

1. Click a meal name to review a meal you **still have to do today**.
2. **Committee dashboard** shows how the committee scored today.

Asked to rate again? If the mess office changes that meal's menu while you are rating, your review is not saved. The page shows the new dishes so no score is filed under the wrong dish.



Review recorded page, shown after you submit.

7 Committee member dashboard

What a committee member sees after signing in: the committee's scores, and their own record.

Top bar: Dashboard	Address: `/committee/dashboard`	Used by: committee members

7.1 Today's scores and your own count 7.2 Your record, the committee, and what students said

7.1 Today's scores and your own count

The first four cards are the whole committee: today's score, how many members have reviewed, the 7-day average and the lowest-scoring area.

1. **My reviews this month** counts the meal reviews you have filed.
2. **My last review** shows your most recent score and its date.
3. **Sign out** is here, at the top right of the page.

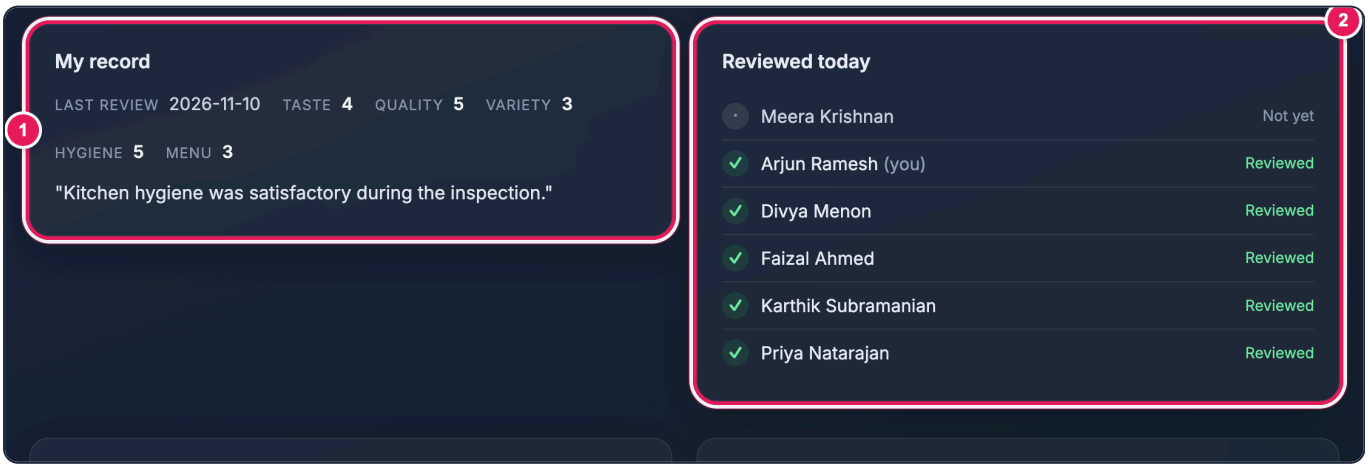


Committee member dashboard, top of the page.

7.2 Your record, the committee, and what students said

1. **My record** repeats your last review, area by area, with what you wrote.
2. **Reviewed today** lists every member. Your own name is marked **(you)**.

Below these two cards, **What students said today** is shown **for context only** and is **never mixed into the committee score**. Beside it, **Committee Reviews** lists the written reviews, newest first, with the member's name, date and meal.



Lower part of the page. The two charts above these cards are explained under Committee dashboard.

8 Student feedback dashboard

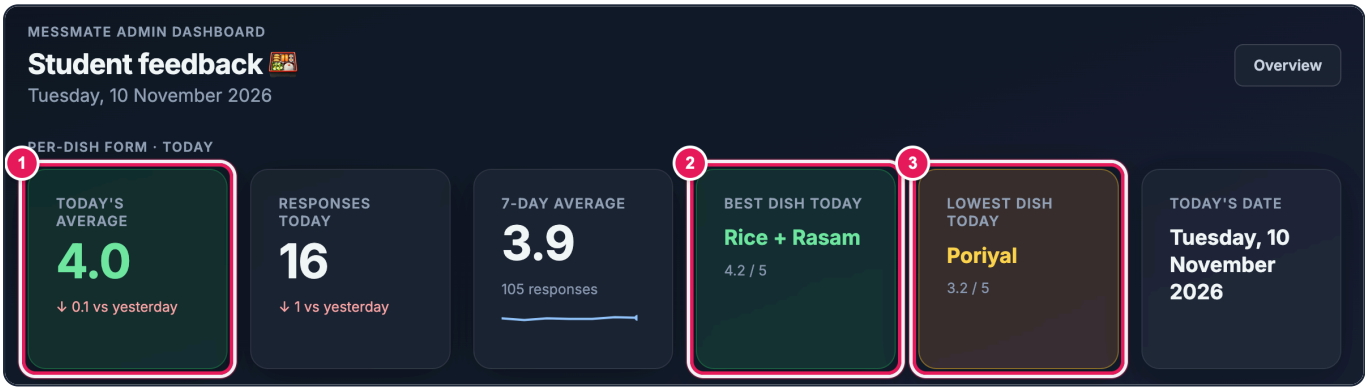
Everything students told you, from the dish form and from the quick taps. The two are shown in separate parts of the page.

Top bar: Students	Address: `/dashboard`	Used by: admin, dean

8.1 The dish form numbers 8.2 The trend and each dish's score 8.3 Quick taps, meal by meal
8.4 What students asked for

8.1 The dish form numbers

1. **Today's average** is students' overall score out of 5. The small line under it compares with yesterday.
2. **Best dish today**, with its score.
3. **Lowest dish today**. This is the dish to look into first.



Student feedback dashboard, top of the page.

8.2 The trend and each dish's score

1. Click **1 month** to see 30 days instead of 7. Click **7 days** to go back.

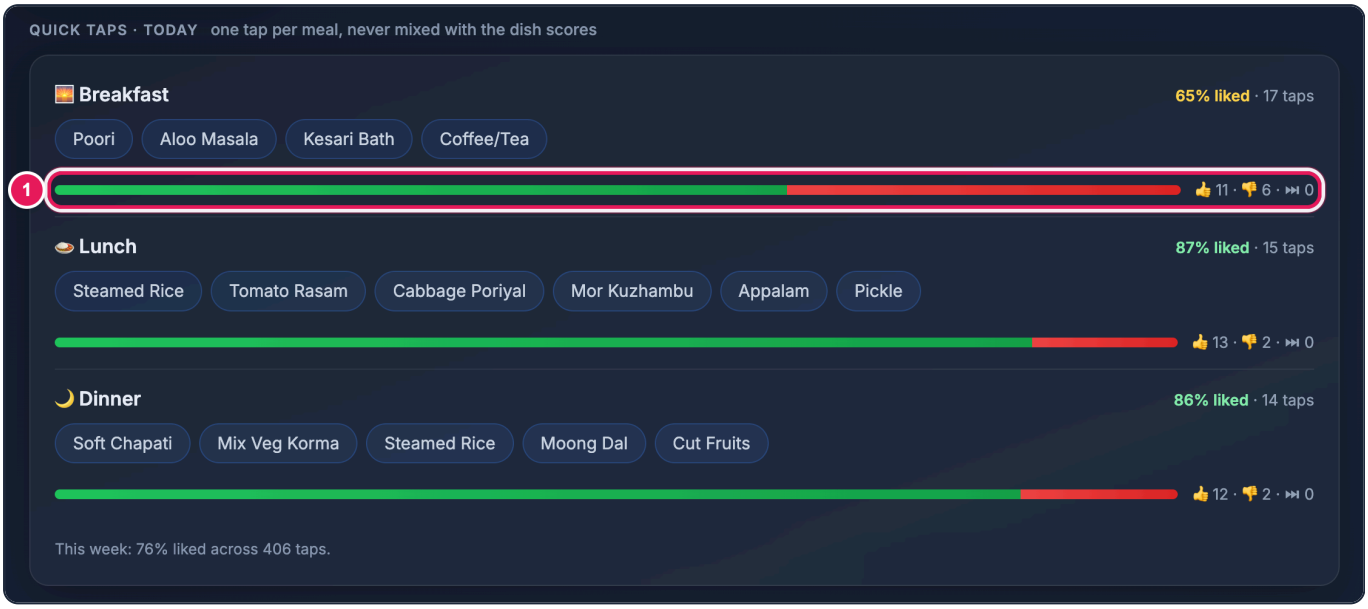


Charts. Left: the daily average. Right: today's score for each dish on the form.

8.3 Quick taps, meal by meal

1. The bar shows the taps for that meal: **green is Good**, **red is Bad**. The figures on the right are Good, Bad and Skipped, then the **% liked**.

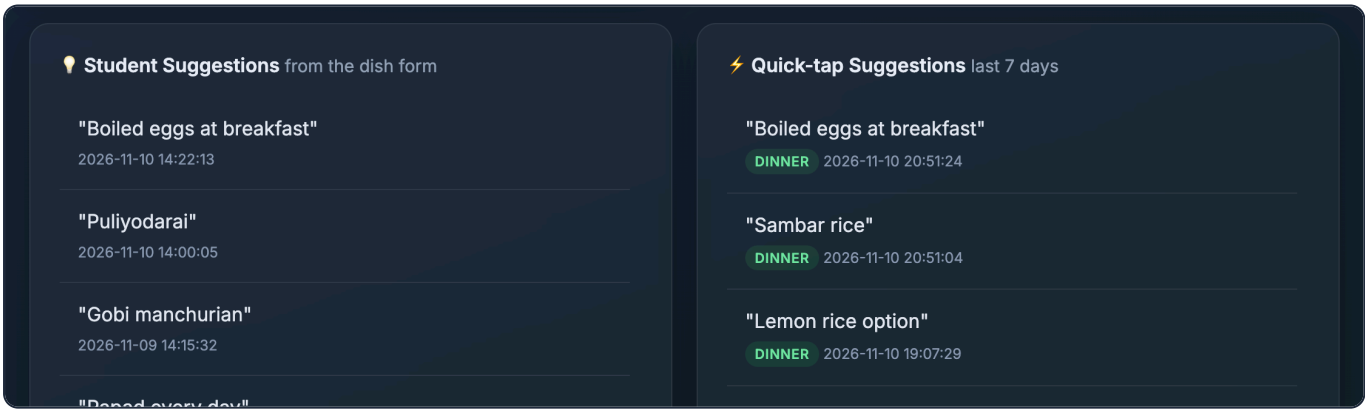
Skips do not lower the score. The percentage counts only students who ate the meal.



Quick taps card. One row per meal, with that meal's dishes.

8.4 What students asked for

The left list holds suggestions typed on the **dish form**. The right list holds notes added to a **quick tap**, each tagged with its meal. Both are **anonymous**.



Suggestions, at the bottom of the page. Both lists scroll.

9 Committee dashboard

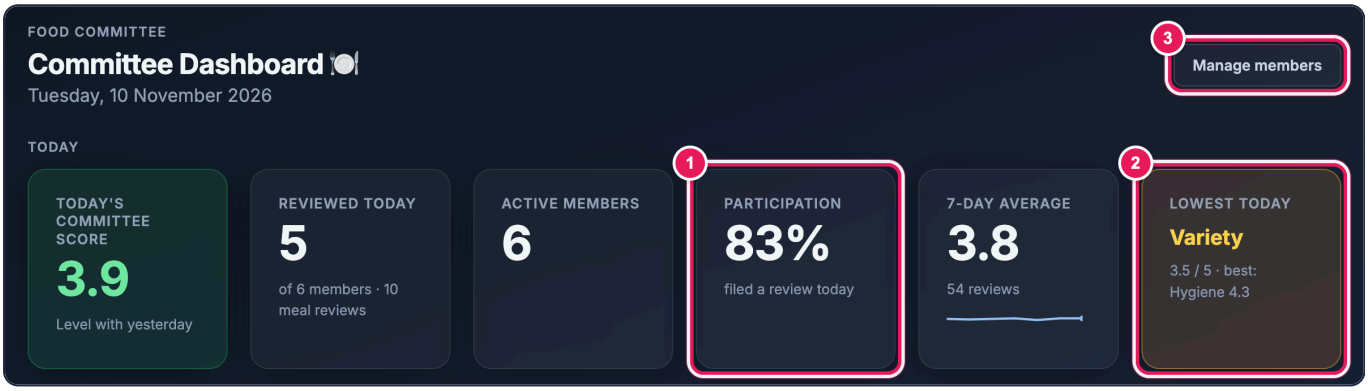
How the Food Committee scored the mess, who took part, and what they wrote.

Top bar: Committee	Address: `/dashboard/committee`	Used by: admin, dean

9.1 Score and participation 9.2 The five areas and the trend 9.3 Who reviewed, and what they wrote

9.1 Score and participation

1. **Participation** is the share of active members who filed a review today.
2. **Lowest today** names the weakest of the five areas, and the best one beside it.
3. **Manage members** opens the Members page. Only an admin sees this button.



Committee dashboard, top of the page.

9.2 The five areas and the trend

1. Click **1 month** to see 30 days instead of 7.

The left chart shows today's score for each of the five areas. A bar that is **amber or red** is the area to raise with the kitchen. Click an area name under the right chart to add its line to the trend.



Charts. Left: today by area. Right: the committee score day by day.

9.3 Who reviewed, and what they wrote

Reviewed today lists every active member. **Committee Reviews** shows each written review with the **member's name**, the date and the meal, so you can follow up with the right person.



Committee dashboard, bottom of the page.

10 What students see

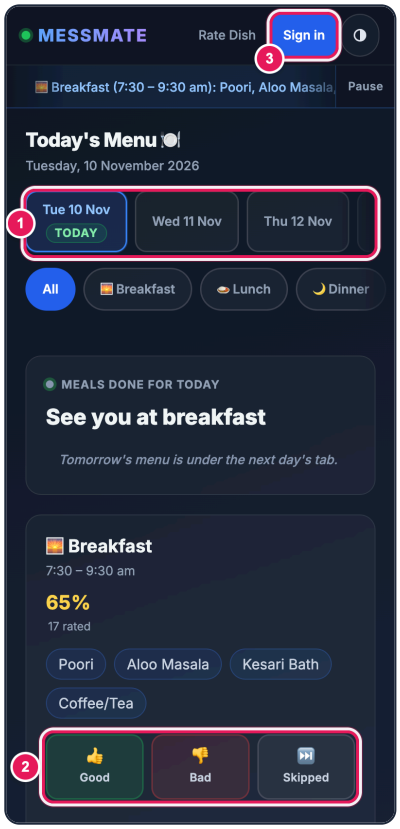
Students open this page on a phone and **never sign in**.

Address: `/home`	Used by: everyone, no sign-in

10.1 Today's menu and one tap per meal

1. The **day tabs** show the rest of the week's menu. Only **today** can be rated.
2. Each meal has three buttons: **Good**, **Bad** and **Skipped**. A student taps one after eating.
3. **Sign in** is where you, the committee and management sign in.

Rule	What it means
One tap per meal per day	Each phone can rate breakfast, lunch and dinner once each
Only after the meal starts	Buttons stay grey until serving time: breakfast 7:30 am, lunch 12:00 pm, dinner 7:30 pm
Undo for 10 minutes	A student can press **Undo** within 10 minutes. After that the tap is final
"Menu not published yet"	The mess office has not published that meal. Students can still rate it after eating
Nothing tied to the student	No name, email, roll number or IP address is stored



Student page on a phone. The percentage is the share who liked the meal.

11 Colours and quick answers

The same colours mean the same thing on every page.

11.1 What the colours mean 11.2 Quick answers

11.1 What the colours mean

Colour	Score out of 5 (dish form, committee)	% liked (quick taps)	Read it as
Green	Above 3.5	70% and above	Going well
Amber	2.5 to 3.5	40% to 69%	Watch it
Red	**Below 2.5**	**Below 40%**	**Needs action**
Grey --	No data yet		**Not a zero**

11.2 Quick answers

Question	Answer
"Incorrect email or password"	Check the email is the one the admin registered. New members use the **one-time password**, not one of their own.
A member forgot their password	Admin: **Members**, then **Reset password** on their row. Send them the new one-time password.
I closed the page before copying a one-time password	It cannot be shown again. Click **Reset password** to make a new one.
Students say the menu is missing	That meal is not published. Open **Menu**, type the dishes and click **Save**.
I typed the menu but students cannot see it	You have not saved. Click **Save** on the day, or **Save all 7 days**.
The Submit review button will not click	Rate **every dish** and **all five areas** first.
A meal tab says "Reviewed" and shows no form	You have already reviewed that meal today. Pick an amber meal.
A card shows "--"	Nobody has rated yet. It is not a score of zero.
A member has left the committee	Admin: **Members**, then **Deactivate**. Their past reviews are kept.
Can the three scores be combined into one?	**No.** Quick taps, the dish form and committee reviews measure different things from different people, so MessMate keeps them apart.

Can the mess office edit the Google Sheet directly? Yes. Staff can type the menu straight into the `menu` tab, one row per date. Those edits reach students **within 30 seconds**.